

A Special Meeting of the Board of Aldermen was held Saturday, November 15, 2025, at 9:00 a.m. in the City Hall Auditorium.

President Lori Wilshire presided; City Clerk Daniel Healey recorded.

Prayer was offered by City Clerk Daniel Healey; Alderman-at-Large Michael B. O'Brien, Sr., led in the Pledge to the Flag.

Let's start the meeting by taking a roll call attendance.

The roll call was taken with 13 members of the Board of Aldermen present: Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Thibodeau, Alderman Gouveia, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Clemons, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Jette, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman Klee, Alderman Dowd, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Wilshire.

Members not in Attendance: Alderman Moran, Alderman Lopez.

#### COMMUNICATIONS

From: Daniel Healey, City Clerk

Re: Recount requests for Ward 1 Alderman, Ward 5 Alderman, and Ward 6 Alderman

***Without objection, President Wilshire accepted the communication and placed it on file.***

#### UNFINISHED BUSINESS - RESOLUTION

##### **R-25-211**

Endorser: Mayor Jim Donchess

**RELATIVE TO THE SUPPLEMENTAL APPROPRIATION OF \$148,035.89 OF UNANTICIPATED REVENUE INTO FUND #7024 "OPIOID ABATEMENT EXPENDABLE TRUST FUND"**

**MOTION BY ALDERMAN O'BRIEN TO CLARIFY THE MOTION THAT WAS MADE ON NOVEMBER 13, 2025 WHEREBY THE TITLE OF RESOLUTION R-25-211 WAS INCORRECTLY STATED AS "RELATIVE TO THE ACCEPTANCE OF A HORSE TRAILER DONATED TO THE CITY OF NASHUA POLICE DEPARTMENT BY FRIENDS OF THE NASHUA POLICE DEPARTMENT MOUNTED UNIT" AND SHOULD HAVE READ "RELATIVE TO THE SUPPLEMENTAL APPROPRIATION OF \$148,035.89 OF UNANTICIPATED REVENUE INTO FUND #7024 "OPIOID ABATEMENT EXPENDABLE TRUST FUND"**

##### **MOTION CARRIED**

Resolution R-25-211 is declared duly adopted.

#### DISCUSSION

- Canvas of Returns on November 4, 2025 Municipal General Election Request for Recount of Votes Cast for Wards 1, 5, and 6 Race

##### President Wilshire

Mr. Clerk, I'm going to turn it over to you.

##### Dan Healey, City Clerk

So we're here today. We had a recount request for Ward 1, Ward 5, and Ward 6. We have a meeting scheduled to start at 9 a.m. for those recounts. I had sent letters to all the candidates and indicated that Ward 5 won't start until at least 10 a.m. and then Ward 6 won't start until 11 a.m. At that time if needed, I'll go over the recount procedures, again, if more people from those wards show up.

So what we're going to be doing here is we have all the boxes from those Wards up here. These include cast, uncast, absentees. We're going to open every box and show what the contents are of those boxes. If there are fully uncast ballots, we're going to fan through them. Each person, each candidate will have the opportunity to have an observer up front to see the fanning through to confirm that they're uncast. They'll go back in the box and be sealed.

The absentee envelopes, we're fanning through those just to make sure there's no ballot in there that, you know, shouldn't be that should be with the cast ballots but the absentee ballots – the opportunity to challenge an actual absentee ballot was on election day. So there's no challenges to the envelopes, only to ballots.

Then the third box, the third set of boxes will be the cast ballots. The procedure that we're going to use today is that these first two tables will be sorting the ballots based off of what the voter chose. The first person will read off the name that they believe the ballot to be for, they'll pass it to the second person that will hold it up for the observers, and after a few seconds, they'll place it in the box. Once the ballot is placed in that box, once it hits the box, the time for a challenge is over on that ballot. Periodically, team members, City Clerk staff, and volunteers – Tina Guilford, Derry Town Clerk, and Cassie who works for the City Clerk's office here in Nashua, and myself will be coming around and swapping out the boxes with the counting table that's in the back corner of the room. The two back tables.

At the counting table, each person will count into stacks of 25 for that candidate or that choice. The first person will count into 25 and put an elastic around it. He'll pass it to the second person who will take the elastic off, count 25, put the elastic back on, and a sticky note indicating that it was counted for a second time. Once they are finished with that, the ballots will come back to this table. They'll be held til the end where myself and staff will go through the piles and tally the results up. At that time, again, an observer from each candidate can be present.

If there are any challenges during the process, those will be taken, they'll be brought up to this table up here, place them in this box here, and they will go to the Aldermen at the end of that Ward, the recount, the Aldermen will rule on the ballots. We do have one Alderman that will not be able to rule on the Ward 6 ballots so at that time, they'll recuse themselves from the Ward 6 ballots as they are a candidate but they are able to rule on Ward 1 and Ward 5. Are there any questions now at this time?

Unidentified Speaker

If I do the first count, who does the second count?

Dan Healey, City Clerk

The person at your table next to you. Whoever does the first count, you should do the first count. The other person does the second count consistently. So I don't want you to do the first count. You do the first count, he does the second count, or vice versa but keep it consistent throughout.

Are there any other questions? Okay.

For the Ward 1 candidates are you both present? Do you want to come forward. Now do you each have observers? Okay, your observers can be – if they're not already seated, they can be seated at this time. So each candidate gets four observers and then themselves. Each observer gets to sit at one of the tables. So those are the only people that will be allowed in the recount area. So we need more seating on this end.

Okay. So at this time if the two candidates or one of their designees wants to come to the front, we're going to be going to beginning to open the boxes. I failed to mention this but during the recount process, there should be no side conversations. If you want to have a conversation, go out in the hall. They need to be able to hear what's going on, on this side of the room. So any conversation, you need to go out in the hall. If it gets disruptive, I'm going to give warnings and then I'm going to ask you to leave but we need it quiet in the room.

Okay so after the re-count of Ward 1, the current numbers that we have, we have six challenge ballots but for the candidates currently, Stephen Chess has 979 votes. On election night, it was reported at 982. Hailey Gallagher has 942 votes. Election night was reported at 945. We have three write-ins for non-candidates. We have three over votes and we have 5,700 votes. So at this time, the six challenge ballots will be sent to the Aldermen unless there's any objection from any of the candidates or we'll send them.

Okay. We will tally them with the two candidates.

So at this time with the challenge ballots now resolved, we have 982 votes for Stephen Chess during the recount and we had 982 for Stephen Chess on election night. For Hailey Gallagher, we have 945 votes and on election night, we had 945 votes. The write-ins – 3, over votes – 3, under votes – 57.

Unidentified Speaker

Do we do a motion to accept?

Alderman Klee

We need a motion to accept.

**MOTION BY ALDERMAN O'BRIEN TO ACCEPT THE RECOUNT RESULTS OF WARD 1  
MOTION CARRIED**

Dan Healey, City Clerk

So at this time, I'm going to take a few minutes to box up Ward 1 and then we'll get started on the Ward 5 recount, but we just wanted to get these all in the boxes and sealed up, and out of the way, and then we'll bring the Ward 5 ballots out to the table.

So currently Ward 5 on election night – Paula Johnson – 635. Right now with 13 challenges still pending, Paula Johnson – 632. Jennice Chewlin on election night – 421. Currently in the recount, 421. Brenda Garneau on election night – 187. Currently, 186. Justin Gerstenfield on election night – 610. Currently, 600. We had 13 challenges.

So at this time to do the challenges, we'd have one representative from each come to the stage and then we'd go through the challenges, unless the candidates agree on them here.

Okay, so the way that the Charter states is that the Board of Aldermen make a rule in any of the challenged ballots. We have a precedent for the Clerk reading the intent and then passing it to the Aldermen for all of them to look at it and then one of the Alderman will make a motion on what the ballot is for a candidate.

So the first ballot, I believe, is a vote for Paula Johnson and I'm going to pass it to the Aldermen so they can all see it and then they'll determine if that is correct.

**MOTION BY ALDERMAN O'BRIEN TO RECOGNIZE ON THAT PARTICULAR BALLOT PAULA JOHNSON TO BE  
THE WINNER  
MOTION CARRIED**

Dan Healey, City Clerk

This ballot I believe to be a ballot for Justine Gerstenfield.

**MOTION BY ALDERMAN O'BRIEN THAT THE BALLOT AS SHOWN RECOMMEND JUSTIN GERSTENFIELD  
MOTION CARRIED**

Dan Healey, City Clerk

Vote for Justin Gerstenfield.

**MOTION BY ALDERMAN O'BRIEN THAT THE BALLOT THAT WAS SHOWN TO US MAKE THE  
RECOMMENDATION OF JUSTIN GERSTENFIELD  
MOTION CARRIED**

Dan Healey, City Clerk

So if you want to drop the challenge to any of these ballots, we would just read these off so that we can tally them – the remainder – and they wouldn't have to go to the Board. Are you both agreeable to them? Okay.

So at this time with all the votes being cast and counted during the recount, I'm going to go over the numbers one more time. Paula Johnson election night – 635; recount – 634. Jennice Chewlin election night – 421; recount – 421. Brenda Garneau election night – 187; recount – 187; Justin Gerstenfield election night – 610; recount – 610. Then we had one write in, one over voter, and 37 under votes. The ballot that was left in the tabulator box was distributed to the table and counted.

So at this time, I'll go over it just the re-count results so the Board and certify those. Paula Johnson – 634, Jennice Chewlin – 421, Brenda Garneau – 187, and Justin Gerstenfield – 610. So we'll need a motion to accept those results.

**MOTION BY ALDERMAN O'BRIEN TO RECOGNIZE PAULA JOHNSON AS THE WINNER OF THE WARD 5 ELECTION AND TO ACCEPT THE RESULTS OF THE RE-COUNT**  
**MOTION CARRIED**

Dan Healey, City Clerk

Okay, again, it will be a few minutes to box these up and then we'll begin the re-count for Ward 6.

So for Ward 6 election night I show Chris Thibodeau with 468. The recount today, 469. Election night for Vengerflutta Smith – 490. The re-count today – 491.

**MOTION BY ALDERMAN O'BRIEN FOR VENGERFLUTTA SMITH AND ACCEPTING THE RESULTS OF THE WARD 6 RE-COUNT**

ON THE QUESTION

Alderwoman Kelly

I just wanted to know where the last time it was caught in the machine. Do you know where the two additional ballots came from? Would it something obvious like that?

Dan Healey, City Clerk

So that is what the re-count team found was that there was an additional vote for each candidate. Sometimes when you look at the ballot, there's a different determination. So when the ballots are looked at by people, you can maybe make a different determination on voter intent.

**MOTION CARRIED – Alderman Thibodeau abstained.**

President Wilshire

The results are for Vengerflutta Smith.

Dan Healey, City Clerk

For the record, I am going to go over the results one more time and then the Board of Aldermen will then make a motion on that and declare the races official.

So for Ward 1 – Stephen Chess – 982, Hailey Gallagher – 945.

For Ward 5 – Paula Johnson – there was a minor correction when we were looking at the tally sheet, I had announced earlier 634. It was actually 635 which is the same number from election night. So it's 635 for Paula Johnson; 421 for Jennice Chewlin; 187 for Brenda Garneau; and 610 for Justin Gerstenfield.

For Ward 6 – Chris Thibodeau – 469; and Vengerflutta Smith – 491.

**MOTION BY ALDERMAN O'BRIEN TO CERTIFY RECOUNT RESULTS AS READ BY THE CITY CLERK AND DECLARE THE CANDIDATES WITH THE TOP VOTES AS THE OFFICIAL WINNERS OF THE ELECTION**  
**MOTION CARRIED**

ADJOURNMENT

**MOTION BY ALDERMAN O'BRIEN THAT THE NOVEMBER 15, 2025, SPECIAL MEETING OF THE BOARD OF ALDERMEN BE ADJOURNED**  
**MOTION CARRIED**

The meeting was declared adjourned at 3:38 p.m.

Attest: Daniel Healey, City Clerk